FOR PARENTS · SUPPORTING YOUR YOUNG PLAYER

HANDLING SETBACKS & LOSS

Every player falls. Champions get back up.

THE QUICK VERSION

> Bench time, losses, mistakes and tough coaches are all part of sport. These moments hurt, and they're also exactly where resilience is built. Your role isn't to fix it. It's to help your child feel it, learn from it and go again.

WHAT'S REALLY GOING ON

When kids hit a setback, our instinct is to rush in and make the hurt go away, by blaming the referee, the coach or a teammate. But kids who learn to sit with disappointment and then take one small step forward develop a resilience that serves them in school, work and life, not just on the pitch.

THE 3-STEP RESET

1

FEEL IT

Let the emotion out. Listen. No fixing, no lectures. "That really hurts, doesn't it."

2

LEARN IT

Once they're calm, maybe the next day: "What's one thing you'd take from that?"

3

GO AGAIN

Pick one small action for this week: a skill to practise, a question for the coach.

COMMON SETBACKS AND HOW TO HELP

BENCH TIME

Focus on what they control: effort at training, being a great teammate, asking the coach what to work on.

LOSING

Let them be disappointed. Later, find one positive and one lesson together.

MISTAKES

Every great player has missed an open goal. What matters is the very next action.

STRICT COACHES

Firm and fair can be good for growth. Harsh, belittling or unsafe is never okay, so speak to the club.

Success occurs when opportunity meets preparation.

TRY THIS

1 Keep your own reaction calm
Your child reads your face first. Stay steady, even if you're gutted too.

2 Don't rush to blame
Blaming others feels good short term, but it takes away their chance to grow.

3 Share real stories
Every pro has been benched, dropped or beaten. Look up a favourite player's story together.

4 Celebrate the bounce-back
Notice and praise when they get back up, try again or keep going.

SAY THIS, NOT THAT

SAY THIS	NOT THAT
"It's okay to be upset."	~~"Stop crying, it's just a game."~~
"What's one thing you'd do differently?"	~~"Why on earth did you do that?"~~
"Mistakes mean you're trying."	~~"You cost us the game."~~

QUICK SELF-CHECK

- [ ] I let my child feel disappointment without fixing it
- [ ] I avoid blaming refs, coaches or teammates
- [ ] We talk about lessons once emotions settle
- [ ] I notice and praise their bounce-back

Can't tick them all yet? That's normal. Pick one to work on this week.

COACH'S CORNER

"Every player you admire has been dropped, benched or beaten. Setbacks don't end careers. Giving up does.

THE FUTURE BALLER TEAM